



Criminal Rush

Save the City ... or Control It

Rule Book



Components:

160 cards, 23 tokens, 2 boards, 40 cubes



Criminal Rush

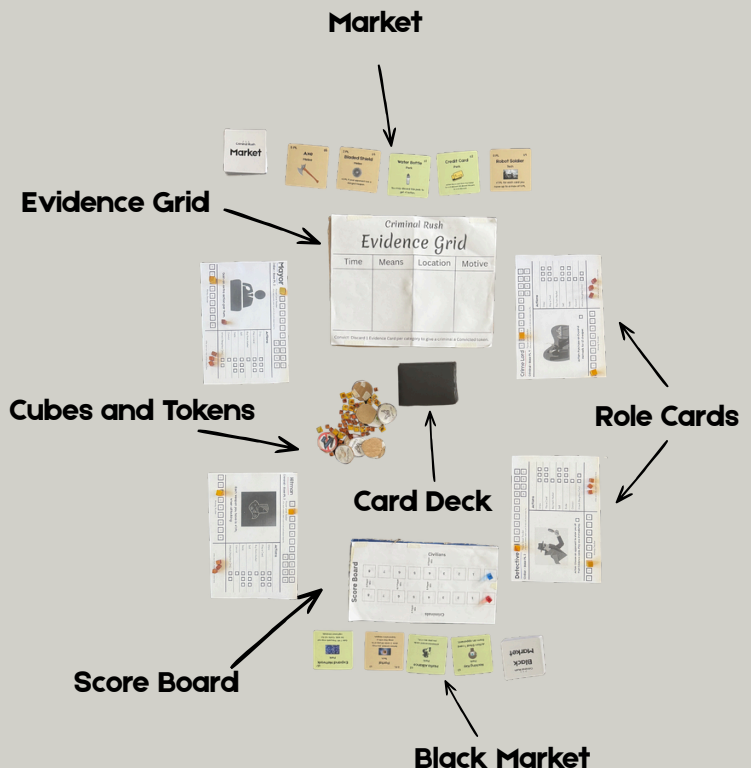
Save the City ... or Control It

Beneath the shining skyline of Nocturne lies darkness. A ruthless criminal syndicate is expanding its influence through fear, corruption, and attacks on innocent civilians. With every crime committed, their network grows stronger, bringing Nocturne one step closer to falling under their control. Standing against them is an unlikely force: a team of rookie detectives. Civilians by day and investigators by night, they must gather evidence, expose criminal operations, and bring the syndicate to justice before it's too late. Every decision shapes the city's future.

Will you save Nocturne City... or seize control of it?

1 Set Up

- 1. Choose the # of Civilian and Criminal Roles based on total # of players. See table on page 2.**
- 2. Deal role cards to players so that Civilians and Criminals alternate. Recommended first game roles are in the appendix.**
- 3. Give each player 2 large cubes to track Power Level (PL) and Money and 3 small cubes to track actions.**
- 4. Deal out starting cards and set starting money based on # of total players.**
- 5. Set up the Market (5 cards) and Black Market (3 cards and Expand Networks).**
- 6. Set up an Evidence Grid and Victory Point (VP) chart at the center.**
- 7. Civilians go first. Play proceeds clockwise. In odd-player games, the Civilian after another Civilian starts. Otherwise, the Civilians choose the starting player.**



Example set up for 4 player game

	4 Players		5 Players		6 Players	
VPs	4	5	4		6	
	Civilians	Criminals	Civilians	Criminals	Civilians	Criminals
Players	2	2	3	2	3	3
Cards	5	3	3	3	5	3
\$	2	2	2	2	3	2

	7 Players		8 Players	
VPs	6		8	
	Civilians	Criminals	Civilians	Criminals
Players	4	3	4	4
Cards	3	3	5	3
\$	3	2	3	2

of VPs needed to win, starting cards, and starting money based on # of players

2 Objective

The first team to reach the # of VPs based on the # of players wins the game.

Civilians gain 1 VP each time they expose OR capture a Criminal.

Criminals gain 1 VP each time they successfully attack a Civilian OR purchase the Expand Network card.

Both teams score 1 VP when the deck runs out. If both teams reach the # of VPs needed to win at the same time, the Civilians win



Example Score Board



Expand Network is a perk from the Black Market. It starts at \$5 and gets more expensive.

3 Turn Overview

First, resolve any effects from perks or tokens that trigger at the beginning of your turn. Then, begin your turn. You have 3 actions per turn, which you can choose from the following and do in any order:

- 1. Draw a card
- 2. Play a card
- 3. Purchase a perk or weapon (once per turn)
- 4. Sell a perk or weapon
- 5. Role or perk action (each once per turn)
- 6. Trade with a teammate
- 7. Expose (Civilians Only) or Expand Network (Criminals Only)
- 8. Combat (Counts as 2 Actions - Neighbors Only)



Example: If you have the Virus token, you get one less action on your turn.

At the end, if you're an injured Civilian, discard your Injury token to show you're healed and reset action cubes to the box at the bottom of your role card.

4 Role Card Overview

Power Level Tracker: Set to Base PL initially and adjust as your buy weapons and resolve combats.

Role Name

Team and Base Power Level

Role Action

Crime Lord

Criminal - Base PL 4

Action: Purchase an Expand Network for \$1 cheaper.

"Connections are everything."

Power Level Tracker

After each combat, reset to sum of role and weapon base PLs.

3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
							14	15	16	17

Money Tracker

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---

Actions

Draw	☐	☐	☐
Play a Card	☐	☐	☐
Buy	☐		
Sell	☐	☐	☐
Trade	☐	☐	☐
Expand Network	☐		
Attack (Neighbor Only)	☐	☐	

Action Tracker: As you perform actions, place an action cube in the corresponding box.

Money Tracker: Set to starting money and adjust as you lose or gain money. If you exceed \$8, you may use action cubes to represent \$1 each.

4

Action Details

Draw a Card

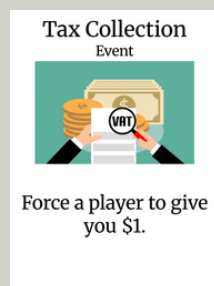
Draw a card from the top of the deck into your hand.

If the draw pile runs out, shuffle the discard to form a new draw pile and both teams score a VP.

Play a Card

Money Cards: Whenever you play a money card, move your Money tracker the corresponding # of spaces.

Event Cards: Place the Event Card in the discard pile and immediately resolve its effect.



Tax Collection is an Event that allows you to steal \$1 from an opponent.

Evidence Cards: For Civilians, play an Evidence card into the corresponding section of the Evidence grid based on its category. If it's an Evidence card with multiple categories, you must choose the category when playing down the card. For Criminals, you may burn the Evidence. Discard the Evidence card to draw 2 new cards from the deck. If all Criminals are exposed, Civilians can play Evidence Cards to gain \$2 each.

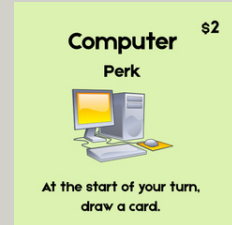
Example of a full Evidence grid

Time	Means	Location	Motive
Forensic Files Evidence WILD CARD (ANY CATEGORY)	Metal Chain Evidence MEANS	Construction Site Bricks Evidence LOCATION OR MEANS	Power Evidence MOTIVE

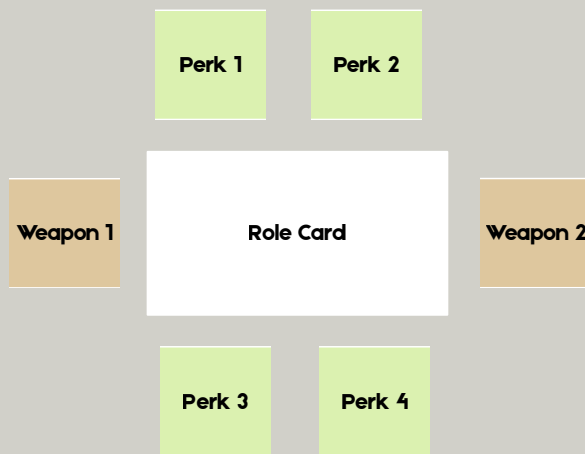
Note that Power cards can only be played during Combat. See Section 6 for more details.

Purchase a perk or weapon

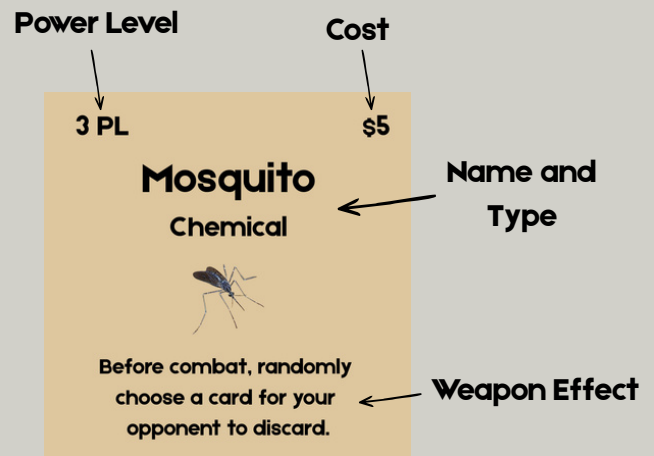
Purchase a perk or weapon, paying the corresponding amount in money. Then, replace the perk or weapon with a new card from the top of the corresponding deck. Civilians may only buy from the Market while Criminals may also choose to buy from the Black Market. This action can only be done once per turn. However, there may be other ways to acquire additional perks or weapons in one turn. You may have a max of 4 perks and 2 weapons total. If a perk comes with an action, you may spend an action to use that perk immediately.



The Computer perk costs \$2 and gives you a draw at the beginning of your turn.



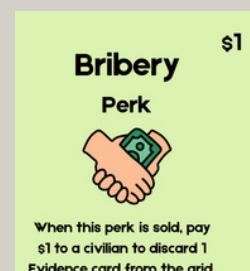
Example organization of purchased weapons and perks.



Anatomy of a weapon

Sell a perk or weapon

You may discard a perk or weapon card to collect \$1. Place it into a discard pile by their respective Market. This opens up space for new perks or weapons to be purchased.



Bribery allows a Criminal to discard an Evidence card when sold.

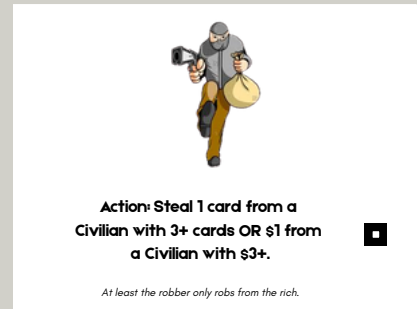
Role or Perk Action

If a role or perk card has “Action”, you may spend an action to activate that effect. Each role or perk action can only be used once per turn. Injured and captured players cannot use their role ability. Place an action cube on the perk to signify it has been used.

As the Robber, you may use your role action to steal from a Civilian.



With the Bank, you may activate it, playing a money card to get an extra \$1 and draw.



Trade with a Teammate

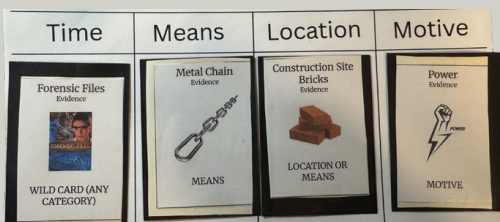
You may give a teammate 1 weapon OR 1 card from your hand OR \$1. Your teammate must then give you 1 weapon OR 1 card from their hand OR \$1 back. You can't give a teammate a weapon card if they have the max amount of 2 already. You can't trade perks.



With Express Shipping, you get a perk from trading.

Expose (Civilians Only)

Discard 1 Evidence card from each category to Expose a Criminal. The Civilians score 1 VP. That Criminal loses 1 PL for the rest of the game and can be attacked by Civilians now.



With a full Evidence grid, a Civilian can spend an action to discard the Evidence cards and expose a Criminal, giving them this Exposed token. Note that it is helpful to place discarded Evidence cards in a separate stack for easy access. See “Leaving Evidence” in Combat Section for more details.

Expand Network (Criminals Only)

Purchase an Expand Network card and gain 1 VP instantly. This perk remains with you for the rest of the game, occupying 1 of the 4 slots.

Combat (Counts as 2 Actions)

This may only be done once per turn (even if you get extra actions through other means). You may only attack one of your neighbors (unless you have a weapon that allows you to attack anyone). Civilians may only fight a Criminal who has been Exposed.

6 Combat

The person initiating the combat is the attacker. Their opponent in the combat is the defender in the combat.

- 1. Before combat begins, resolve effects of weapons such as Portal or Barbed Wire.**
- 2. During combat, take the base power level of the role and add the power levels of the up to 2 weapons the player has. Include power levels gained by perks such as the Vitamin or Bodyguard Token. Use the PL cube to keep track.**
- 3. Then during the Power phase, players may play additional Power cards from their hand to add power. Players will then pass or play their own Power card(s). Adjust your PL cube tracker accordingly.**
- 4. After all players have passed, resolve combat. If the attacker has a higher power, the defender loses and the attacker wins. Otherwise, the attacker loses. Defender wins ties.**

If a Criminal attacks and wins:	If a Civilian attacks and wins:
• The Criminal team scores 1 VP • The Civilian is injured. They grab an “Injured” token to signify that they cannot use their role ability, attack, or be attacked until they are healed at the end of their next turn. • Leaving Evidence: The Civilian may take up to 2 discarded Evidence cards and shuffle them into the draw pile.	• The Civilian team scores 1 VP • The Criminal attacked is captured. Flip over their Exposed token to show the Captured side. They can no longer attack or be attacked. In addition, they lose their role ability permanently. • Weakened Network: Now, the captured Criminal must pay +\$1 to purchase Expand Network in the future.
IF anyone attacks and loses, nothing happens. However, the attacker has spent 2 action points.	

Example Combat

2 PL\$4

Hammer

Melee



Before combat, draw 1 card.

Hitman

2345678910111213141516

Criminal - Base PL 3

Power Level Tracker

After each combat, reset to sum of role and weapon base PLs.



Each weapon you have is +1 PL when attacking

With precise aim and sneaky attacks, the Hitman is ready to strike.

Actions

Draw☐☐☐

Play a Card☐☐☐

Buy☐

Sell☐☐☐

Trade☐☐☐

Expand Network☐

Attack (Neighbor Only)☐☐

1 PL\$2

Barbed Wire

Melee



Before combat, your opponent must discard 1 card of their choice.

The Hitman attacks the Mayor. First, the Hitman draws a card from Hammer while the Mayor discards a card from Barbed Wire.

VS.

2 PL\$4

Harpoon

Ranged



+2 PL if your opponent has a Melee weapon

Mayor

2345678910111213141516

Civilian - Base PL 2

Power Level Tracker

After each combat, reset to sum of role and weapon base PLs.



Gain an extra action per turn. ☐

It's hard to keep a corrupted city afloat. The Mayor has taken things into their own hands to stop the criminal syndicate.

Actions

Draw☐☐☐

Play a Card☐☐☐

Buy from Market☐

Sell☐☐☐

Trade☐☐☐

Expose☐

Attack (Neighbor Only)☐☐

0 PL*\$4

Parasites

Chemical

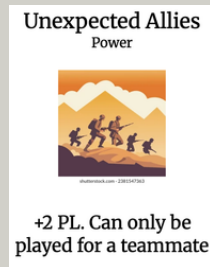
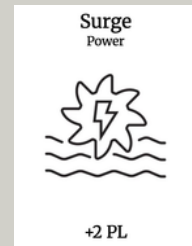


*PL equivalent to your opponent's base PL

The Hitman has a base PL of 3. The Hammer provides 2 PL while Barbed Wire provides 1 PL. The Hitman's ability gives +2 PL for a total of 8 PL.

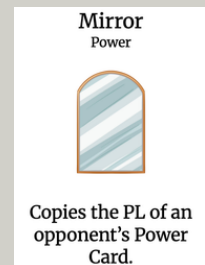
The Mayor has a base PL of 2. Harpoon is 4 PL since the Hitman as Hammer (which is Melee). Parasites is 3 PL since the Hitman has a base PL of 3. This makes a total PL of the Mayor at 9.

The Hitman has calculated that he is behind but does not fret because he has Power cards. During the Power phase, the Hitman plays Surge for +2 PL. Now, he is up by +1 PL.



The Mayor does not have any Power Cards and is ready to give up. But luckily, her teammate plays Unexpected Allies on her behalf, giving her +2 PL.

The Hitman would have lost. However, because of Hammer, he drew into the Mirror. He plays it to copy the Unexpected Allies PL. He gets +2 PL, which allows him to be up by +1 PL again.



The Mayor passes and the Hitman wins. The Criminal team scores 1 VP and the Mayor grabs an Injured token to show she is injured. On her next turn, she will not be able to get an extra action. On the bright side, she notices the team is missing "Time" Evidence so she shuffles in 2 "Time" Evidence cards into the draw pile.

Strategy Tips

For Criminals:

- 1) Your main advantage comes from being able to attack immediately. Thus, if there's an opportunity to confidently defeat a Civilian, take it.
- 2) Take advantage of unique possibilities from the Black Market. But also consider buying from the Market to prevent Civilians from getting Market items.
- 3) One strategy is to stack up the strongest criminal to prevent that criminal from being captured since civilians usually need to capture all criminals to win.

For Civilians:

- 1) Your first priority should be getting extra cards, money, and actions to make your turns more efficient. Weapons help defend you against attacks. As the game goes on, Criminals should get weaker while you get stronger.
- 2) If a fellow Civilian keeps getting attacked, help them get stronger Weapons and/or Power cards.
- 3) To score VPs, lay out Evidence whenever you have it available. Communicate with your team.

Appendix

Event Cards (22 total)

When you play an Event card, resolve its effect immediately and place them in the discard pile. There are 2 copies of each Event card.

Name	Effect
Receive Package	Draw 3 cards.
Market Access	Purchase a perk or weapon from the Market for a \$1 discount
Tax Collection	Force a player to give you \$1.
Gain Influence	Choose a player to randomly take a card from their hand. If it is Evidence, you may immediately play it (or burn it if you're a Criminal).
Market Exchange	Give a perk to a teammate or take a perk from a teammate. Then, draw a card.
Ally Support	Copy a role or perk action of a teammate.
Business Opportunity	Sell a perk or weapon for its cost + \$1 back.
Lottery	Reveal the top 3 cards of the deck. Immediately play any money cards. Discard the rest.
Spring Cleaning	Discard 3 cards from the Market and replace them. Then, you may purchase 1 perk from the Market for a \$1 discount.
Generational Wealth	You and your teammates each get \$1.
Traffic Jam	Give an opponent a Traffic token. Traffic Token: Trading with you costs 2 actions. Action: Pay \$1 to discard this traffic token.

Power Cards (16 total)

Power Cards are played during combat to add additional power. With the exception of Unexpected Allies, you can only play Power Cards for yourself.

Name	Effect	# of Copies
Boost	+1 PL	7
Surge	+2 PL	3
Shield	+3 PL. Can only be played on defense.	2
Unexpected Allies	+2 PL. Can only be played for a teammate.	3
Mirror	Copies the PL of another player's Power card.	1

Money Cards (21 total)

Name	Effect	# of Copies
Spare Change	\$1	5
Profit	\$2	11
Collection	\$3	5

Evidence Cards (21 total)

Categories	# of Copies	Categories	# of Copies
Time	3	Wild (Any Category)	3
Location	3	Time + Location	1
Means	3	Time + Means	1
Motive	3	Time + Motive	1

Categories	# of Copies	Catgories	# of Copies
Location + Means	1	Means + Motive	1
Location + Motive	1		

Market Information

There are 5 cards available to buy from the Market at all times.

Perks (22 Total - 2 of each except for * perks, which only have 1)		
Name	Cost	Effect
Alarm Clock	\$3	Action: Play an event card. Then, draw 1 card AND gain \$1.
Radio	\$2	You may trade for one less action once per turn.
Recycling Bin*	\$2	Action: Discard a card to pick up a card of the same type from the discard pile. Then, gain \$1 OR draw 1 card.
Journal*	\$1	After playing an event card, you may discard this perk card to repeat the effects of the event card.
Express Shipping	\$2	After you trade during your turn, gain \$1 OR draw 1 card.
Water Bottle*	\$1	You may discard this water bottle for an extra action.
Credit Card	\$2	Action: You may purchase a perk or weapon from the Market for a \$1 discount OR you may discard this credit card for a \$2 discount.
Investment	\$2	At the start of your turn, gain \$1. You may not sell this perk.
Computer	\$2	At the start of your turn, draw a card.
Bank	\$3	Action: Play a money card for +\$1 value AND then draw a card.
Coffee Machine	\$3	When purchased, give a teammate or yourself a coffee token. Action: Replenish the Coffee. You may move it to another teammate. Coffee Token: At the beginning of your turn, gain +1 action and draw 1 card. Then, flip this token over.

Vitamin	\$3	At the start of your turn, move the vitamin tracker to the next location, gaining the reward. 1. Draw a card 2. Gain \$1 3. +1 PL for the rest of the game 4. +1 PL for the rest of the game
Trash Can*	\$2	At the beginning of your turn, discard 1 perk/weapon from the Market and place it beneath this trash can. Action: Purchase a perk/weapon from the trash can for a \$1 discount.

Weapons (20 total)			
Name	Cost	Type	Effect
Bat	\$3	Melee	+2 power
Pocket Knife	\$4	Melee	+1 power for each perk and weapon you have (including this)
Switch Blade	\$4	Melee	+2 power, +2 power if your opponent has a Chemical weapon
Hammer	\$4	Melee	+2 power. Before combat, draw a card.
Axe	\$5	Melee	+5 power
Arrows	\$3	Ranged	+2 power
Pistol	\$4	Ranged	+4 power. Before combat, you must discard a card (if possible).
Harpoon	\$4	Ranged	+2 power, +2 power if your opponent has a Melee weapon
Catapult	\$4	Ranged	+2 power. You may attack opponents who are not your neighbors. +3 power in 4 player games.
Machine Gun	\$5	Ranged	+3 power. During the Power phase, you may discard any # of Money cards, with each one adding +1 power. You may attack opponents who are not your neighbors.
Electric Baton	\$3	Tech	+2 power

Missile	\$4	Tech	+2 power. After combat, if you won the combat with this missile, destroy one of your opponent's perk(s).
Magnetic Deflector	\$4	Tech	+2 power, +2 power if your opponent has Ranged weapon
Signal Jammer	\$5	Tech	+2 power. Your opponent may not play Power cards during the Power phase.
Robot Soldier	\$4	Tech	+1 power for every card you have to a max of +5 power
Toxic Gas	\$3	Chemical	+2 power
Viruses	\$4	Chemical	+2 power After combat, give your opponent a Virus token. They lose an action on their next turn.
Corrosion Cannisters	\$4	Chemical	+2 power, +2 power if your opponent has a Tech weapon
Parasites	\$4	Chemical	Equivalent to your opponent's role power level.
Mosquitos	\$5	Chemical	+3 power. Before combat, randomly choose a card for your opponent to discard.

Black Market Information

There will be 3 cards available to buy from the Black Market at all times in addition to Expand Network, which is arranged from cheapest to most expensive.

10 Perks + 4 Expand Networks		
Name	Cost	Effect
Hacked Passwords	\$3	Action: Choose a player and randomly steal a card from their hand.
Mafia Alliance	\$2	All Power cards you play are worth +1 power.
Getaway Car	\$3	Initiating combat only costs 1 action. At the start of your turn, you may give this perk to a teammate and give them 1 card.

Manipulate	\$2	Action: Look at the top 3 cards of the deck. Take 1 to your hand, discard the other, and place the other at the top of the draw.
Bribery	\$1	When this perk is sold, pay \$1 to a Civilian to discard 1 Evidence card from the grid.
Laboratory	\$3	At the start of your turn, draw a card. All of your Chemical/Tech weapons are worth +1 PL.
Ironworks	\$3	At the start of your turn, get \$1. All of your Melee/Ranged weapons are worth +1 PL.
Shady Press	\$2	Action: Choose a player to show you all Event cards they have. Choose one to play immediately.
Corrupt Connections	\$3	At the start of your turn, gain an extra action this turn.
Disguise	\$1	When purchased, draw 2 cards. You may not be exposed with this perk. At the start of your turn, discard this perk.
Expand Network	\$5 - \$8	Gain 1 VP when acquired. This may not be sold or traded. Costs \$1 more for captured criminals.

Weapons (8 Total)			
Name	Cost	Type	
Barbed Wire	\$2	Melee	+1 power. Before combat, your opponent must discard 1 card first (if possible)
Brass Knuckles	\$2	Melee	+1 power. If you are attacking, before combat, steal \$1 from your opponent (if possible).
Molotov Cocktail	\$3	Ranged	+2 power. After combat, choose 1 of your opponent's perks to destroy. The Civilian gains the cost in money back.
Cannon	\$3	Ranged	+1 power for each card your opponent has to a max of +4 power
Portal	\$3	Tech	Before combat, draw 2 cards OR pay \$1 to swap this Portal with a teammate's weapon.
Drones	\$3	Tech	+2 power. Before combat, you may exchange a card with a teammate.
Nerve Agents	\$2	Chemical	+1 power. Attacks against you cost one more action.
Mutants	\$3	Chemical	+1 power. Copies the effect of one of your opponent's weapons.

Roles

**roles are recommended for your first game.*

Role	Role Ability
Mayor * PL: 2	Has +1 action per turn.
Attorney * PL: 3	Whenever a teammate plays an Evidence card into the Evidence Grid, collect \$1.
Collector * PL: 3	Action: Buy a perk or weapon. Then, collect \$1.
Sheriff * PL: 3	Action: Force an opponent to show you all Evidence cards they have. Choose one to play immediately.
Vigilante PL: 2	Each time a Criminal scores a VP, draw one card and gain +1 PL. The max your PL can be increased is +3. The vigilante cannot be injured.
Nurse PL: 3	Whenever a teammate is injured, you may discard 1 card to immediately heal them.
Bodyguard PL: 3	At the beginning of the game, give a teammate the Bodyguard Token. When the Civilian with the token is defending in combat, they gain +2 PL and the Bodyguard may play Power cards for them. Action: Move the bodyguard protection to another Civilian.
Witness PL: 3	When a teammate is injured, you may take 1 discarded Evidence card into your hand OR play 1 Evidence card from your hand.
Crime Lord * PL: 4	Action: Purchase Expand Network for \$1 less.
Hitman * PL: 3	Each weapon you have has +1 PL when attacking.
Spy * PL: 4	At the beginning of your turn, take a look at the top 2 cards of the deck.
Evil Scientist * PL: 3	Action: Buy a Tech or Chemical weapon for a \$1 discount and draw a card.
Robber PL: 2	Action: Steal \$1 from a Civilian that has \$3 or more OR steal 1 card from a Civilian that has 3 cards or more.
Arsonist PL: 3	Action: Choose an opponent. They must either discard 1 card or lose \$1.
Smuggler PL: 3	Action: Move a perk or weapon from the Market into the Black Market. It may be purchased from the Black Market for \$1 cheaper.
Forger PL: 3	Action: Discard one Evidence card to discard one Evidence card from the Evidence Grid of the same category.

Rules Clarification

Market Exchange with Alarm Clock: If you use Alarm Clock ability and then play Market Exchange to give Alarm Clock away, you still get the Alarm Clock ability.

Satellite Ban: Other players may still play Unexpected Allies and your opponent may still discard money with a Machine Gun to gain PL. A Body Guard that is protecting your opponent may still play Reinforcement cards for their teammate.

Mirror: This can only copy the Power Level of a Power card that was played in the combat before the Mirror. For example, if the defender played Shield for +3 PL, the attacker can play the Mirror to gain +3 PL as well. If you play Mirror with Mafia Alliance, it would be worth +1 additional to the PL of the card it is copying. If you play Mirror and your opponent has Mafia Alliance, it would copy the base PL of the card you are copying and not the total PL.

Bodyguard: The Body Guard can play Unexpected Allies for the teammate they are defending. If the Body Guard is injured after a fight, flip over the Body Guard token. That teammate would lose the +2 PL on defense and the Body Guard cannot play Power cards until the Body Guard is healed.

Portal: Use the type of the new weapon after making the swap when considering the effects of Harpoon, Invasive Species, Lasers, and Bladed Shield. If no swap is made, it is considered a Tech weapon.

Ally Support: May not be used to copy the Role Action of a player that is injured or captured.

Gain Influence: If a Criminal draws an Evidence card from playing Gain Influence, they may burn it immediately to draw 2 cards. A Forger may not use their ability immediately with the Evidence card.

Mutants/Robot Soldier/Cannon/Barbed Wire/Hammer/Pistol/Mosquitos: Mutants chooses the weapon to copy first. Then, resolve effects with "Before Combat" such as Hammer and Mosquitos for the attacker first and then defender. Then, resolve effects that affect the PL of the weapon such as Robot Soldier or Cannon. If Mutants copies Robot Soldier, the max is still 5 PL so having 4+ cards makes the Mutants worth 5 PL. If a non-neighbor has Machine Gun or Catapult, you may use Mutants to copy that weapon and attack them.

Vitamin: You gain the reward at the start of your next turn, so you gain nothing immediately from purchasing. When you reach the final stage, you gain +2 PL at all times.

Express Shipping: This only triggers when you are trading during your turn. Exchanging cards with Drones does not trigger this.

Limit of Buying from Market or Black Market: Using Market Access, Credit Card, Spring Cleaning, Trash Can, Collector, Crime Lord, or Evil Scientist does not count towards the limit of buying 1 weapon or perk per turn. You may only buy 1 thing from the Market or Black Market directly per turn.

Shady Press: If your opponent only has 1 Event card and you cannot play it (e.g. Business Opportunity and you don't have a perk or weapon), discard the card instead.